W. Matthew Alampay Davis

Postdoctoral Researcher, Climate Econometrics
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Education

Columbia University	University of Oxford	New York University
Dept. of Economics, GSAS	Nuffield College	Stern School of Business
Ph.D Economics (2025)	*M.Phil* Economics (2019)	*B.S.* Business & Political Economy (2015)

Research

Environmental Economics · Development Economics · Political Economy · Welfare Economics

In progress

Global income distributions and social welfare under climate change

Temperature, institutions, and the political climate

The political economy of identity politics: A theory of descriptive and substantive representation

Evidence of a drought effect on the hazard into spousal violence
with Tanushree Goyal

Published

Large potential reduction in economic damages under UN mitigation targets
with Marshall Burke, Noah S. Diffenbaugh — *Nature* (2018)

Combining satellite imagery and machine learning to predict poverty
with Neal Jean, Marshall Burke, Michael Xie, David B. Lobell, Stefano Ermon — *Science* (2016)

Referee service

Journal of Development Economics (4), *The Econometrics Journal*

Teaching

Graduate Teaching Fellow at Columbia University (nine semesters, 2020–2024)
Research consultant to all UG/MA economics thesis writers and research assistants
ECON-4999 – Senior honors thesis workshops (design and instruction)
ECON-3412 – Introduction to econometrics (TA)
ECON-3211 – Intermediate microeconomics (TA)
ECON-2257 – The global economy (TA)

Affiliations

Research associate at Climate Econometrics (2017–2019)
Nuffield College, University of Oxford

Research associate at Center on Food Security and the Environment (2015–2017)
Dept. of Earth System Science, Stanford University

Honors

Nuffield College Research Fellowship (2026)
Elected in association with two-year appointment as postdoctoral researcher

Program for Economic Research Summer Fellowship (2024)
Columbia economics department award supporting summer research activities

Wueller Fourth-Year Pre-Dissertation Award (2023)
Columbia economics department runner-up best dissertation proposal

UC Berkeley and Sloan Foundation Diversity Fellowship (2022)
Awarded to five North America–based doctoral students in environmental and energy economics

Columbia GSAS Dean's Fellowship and Dissertation Fellowship (2019)
Full-tuition scholarship and living stipend for up to six years of graduate study at Columbia

Oxford M.Phil top-scoring economics thesis (2019)
Department's first 'exceptional' (mark of 80+) thesis in at least four years

Nuffield College–Department of Economics Joint Studentship (2017)

Full-tuition scholarship and living stipend for up to four years of graduate study at Oxford

Updated July 2026